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To Prof. Dr. Milo Puhan

Lausanne, 26 Mai 2026

Dear Prof. Dr. Milo Puhan,

Thank you for allowing us to resubmit an improved version of the manuscript entitled “COVID-19 disrupted patterns of cause-specific mortality in Switzerland” for consideration in the International Journal of Public Health.

We believe that we have addressed all points raised by you and the two reviewers, including concerns regarding novelty and clarity of the work. We provide a detailed point-by-point response to all comments in a separate document. Following these comments, we added several sentences in the introduction to clarify the current evidence gap, both in terms of methodological approaches and existing knowledge on mortality during COVID-19 in Switzerland.

In our responses, we highlighted the passages in the Discussion that already described the added value of the present work and the complementarity of different approaches, and we added the citation suggested by Reviewer 1. Only minor revisions were needed in this section.

We hope these revisions improve the clarity of the manuscript and its contribution to the literature, and that it is now suitable for publication in International Journal of Public Health.

Sincerely,

Dr. Anthony Hauser on behalf of all authors

